

SPANISH VERB CONJUGATIONS - DEBER (TO OWE / SHOULD / MUST)

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PRESENT SIMPLE Regular -er:

Yo debo - I owe / I should

Tú debes - You owe / You should

Él/Ella debe - He/She owes / He/She should

Nosotros debemos - We owe / We should

Vosotros debéis - You all owe / You all should (Spain)

Ellos deben - They owe / They should

PAST SIMPLE (Preterite) Regular:

Yo debí - I owed / I should have

Tú debiste - You owed / You should have

Él/Ella debió - He/She owed / He/She should have

Nosotros debimos - We owed / We should have

Vosotros debisteis - You all owed / You all should have (Spain)

Ellos debieron - They owed / They should have

FUTURE SIMPLE Regular:

Yo deberé - I will owe / I will should

Tú deberás - You will owe / You will should

Él/Ella deberá - He/She will owe / He/She will should

Nosotros deberemos - We will owe / We will should

Vosotros deberéis - You all will owe / You all will should (Spain)

Ellos deberán - They will owe / They will should

PRESENT CONTINUOUS:

Yo **estoy** debiendo - I am owing (rare)

Tú **estás debiendo** - You are owing

Él/Ella **está** debiendo - He/She is owing

Nosotros **estamos debiendo** - We are owing

Vosotros **estáis** debiendo - You all are owing (Spain)

Ellos **están** debiendo - They are owing

⚠️ ****Note****: *Deber* is rarely used in continuous forms for obligation. Use simple present: *Debo estudiar* (NOT ~~Estoy debiendo estudiar~~).

PAST CONTINUOUS:

Yo **estaba debiendo** - I was owing (rare)

Tú **estabas** debiendo - You were owing

Él/Ella **estaba** debiendo - He/She was owing

Nosotros **estábamos** debiendo - We were owing

Vosotros **estabais** debiendo - You all were owing (Spain)

Ellos **estaban** debiendo - They were owing

FUTURE CONTINUOUS:

Yo **estaré debiendo** - I will be owing (rare)

Tú **estarás** debiendo - You will be owing

Él/Ella **estará** debiendo - He/She will be owing

Nosotros **estaremos** debiendo - We will be owing

Vosotros **estaréis** debiendo - You all will be owing (Spain)

Ellos **estarán** debiendo - They will be owing

PRESENT PERFECT:

Yo **he** debido - I have owed / I should have

Tú **has** debido - **You have owed** / You should have

Él/Ella **ha** debido - He/She has owed / He/She should have

Nosotros **hemos** debido - We have owed / We should have

Vosotros habéis debido - You all have owed / You all should have (Spain)

Ellos han debido - They have owed / They should have

PAST PERFECT:

Yo **había** debido - I had owed / I should have had

Tú **habías** debido - **You had owed** / You should have had

Él/Ella **había** debido - He/She had owed / He/She should have had

Nosotros **habíamos** debido - We had owed / **We should have** had

Vosotros habíais debido - You all had owed / You all should have had (Spain)

Ellos habían debido - They had owed / They should have had

FUTURE PERFECT:

Yo **habré** debido - I will have owed / I will should have

Tú **habrás** debido - You will have owed / **You will should have**

Él/Ella **habrá** debido - He/She will have owed / He/She will should have

Nosotros **habremos** debido - We will have owed / We will should have

Vosotros **habréis** debido - You all will have owed / You all will should have (Spain)

Ellos **habrán** debido - They will have owed / They will should have

CONDITIONAL  Regular:

Yo **debería** - I should / I would owe

Tú **deberías** - You should / You would owe

Él/Ella **debería** - He/She should / He/She would owe

Nosotros **deberíamos** - We should / We would owe

Vosotros **deberíais** - You all should / You all would owe (Spain)

Ellos **deberían** - They should / They would owe

COULD/SHOULD (PODER/DEBER + INFINITIVE):

Yo **podría deber + infinitivo** - I could owe/should...

Yo **debería + infinitivo** - I should + verb *(most common!)*

(Example: Debería estudiar = I should study)

EXAMPLE SENTENCES:

- Debería llamar a mi madre hoy.

(I should call my mother today.)

- Debemos terminar el proyecto antes del viernes.

(We must finish the project before Friday.)

- Le debo 20 euros a Juan. (I owe Juan 20 euros.)

 ****Good News About "Deber"**:**

Deber is a ****100% regular -er verb**** — no stem changes, no spelling changes, no irregularities! 🎉

◆ **Pattern to Remember**:

All regular -er verbs follow this same conjugation pattern:

| Ending | Example: Deber | Other -er verbs |

|-----|-----|-----|

| -o | debo | comer → como, beber → bebo |

| -es | debes | comer → comes, beber → bebes |

| -e | debe | comer → come, beber → bebe |

| -emos | debemos | comer → comemos, beber → bebemos |

| -éis | debéis | comer → coméis, beber → bebéis |

| -en | deben | comer → comen, beber → beben |

 Two Main Meanings of "Deber":

| Meaning | Structure | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| **To Owe** (money/favors) | *deber + noun* | *Le debo dinero.* (I owe him money.) |

| **Should/Must** (obligation) | *deber + infinitive* | *Debo estudiar.* (I should study.) |

💡 **Key Tip**: Context tells you which meaning applies! If it's followed by a verb → obligation. If followed by a noun → debt.

 Important Usage Notes: "Deber" vs. "Deber de":

| Structure | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *deber + infinitive* | Obligation (should/must) | *Debes llegar a tiempo.* (You must arrive on time.) |

| *deber **de** + infinitive* | Probability/assumption | *Debe de ser tarde.* (It must be late.) |

|

! **Note**: In modern spoken Spanish, many speakers use *deber* for both meanings, but the distinction is still preferred in formal writing.

Common Phrases with "Deber":

| Phrase | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *debería + infinitive* | I should + verb | *Debería descansar más.* |

| *no deberías* | You shouldn't | *No deberías fumar.* |

| *deberle algo a alguien* | to owe someone something | *Te debo una disculpa.* |

| *cumplir con su deber* | to do one's duty | *Cumplió con su deber como ciudadano.* |

| *más de lo debido* | more than necessary | *Trabaja más de lo debido.* |

| *por deber* | out of duty | *Lo hizo por deber, no por gusto.* |

"Deber" as a Noun: "El Deber" (Duty/Obligation):

| Expression | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *el deber* | duty / obligation | *Es mi deber ayudarte.* |

| *los deberes* | homework / duties | *Los niños hacen sus deberes.* |

| *en cumplimiento del deber* | in the line of duty | *El policía actuó en cumplimiento del deber.* |

Pro Tip — Expressing Advice with "Deber":

The conditional form *debería* is the most natural way to give gentle advice in Spanish:

| English | Spanish |

|-----|-----|

| You should rest. | *Deberías descansar.* |

| We should leave now. | *Deberíamos salir ahora.* |

| He should apologize. | *Él debería disculparse.* |

| Should I call her? | *¿Debería llamarla?*

💡 ****Regional Note****:

In some Latin American countries, *tener que* is often preferred over *deber* for strong obligation:

- *Tengo que irme.* (I have to leave.) — More common in speech

- *Debo irme.* (I must leave.) — Slightly more formal

Both are correct — choose based on the level of formality you want!

✅ ****Ready for the next verb!**** Just say: *"Next verb: [verb]"* 🚀